

Upcoming Requirements and Success Criteria with WCAG 2.2

Introduction and Background

The [WCAG 2.2](#) was published as a "W3C Recommendation" web standard on 5 October 2023 (see [What's New in WCAG 2.2 Working Draft - Introduction, Timeline, Comments](#)). It contains several enhancements and new success criteria.

In addition, while putting the Product Standard Accessibility as well as the upcoming WCAG 2.2 Success Criteria into life, we gained experience in context of how user needs are reflected. This leads to further suggestions for improvement.

Consequently, the Product Standard Accessibility is currently being updated to its version 4.2.

Product Standard Accessibility v4.2 is planned to be rolled out on Feb 8, 2024.

Please find below a summary on how the new criteria are incorporated into the SAP Product Standard Accessibility. Details can be found on the dedicated detail pages. In addition, changes were done based on customer feedback. Next, some editorial changes were done for clarity. The normative parts (new requirements and success criteria) have been approved by the Advisory and Review Board (ARB) for the Product Standard Accessibility.

Foreseeably, the regulations in some countries are going to be adapted soon after publication of WCAG 2.2, so you might wish to check the current status in your software and start to plan. Please note that central testing and reporting will incorporate the new success criteria after the Product Standard Accessibility 4.2 is rolled out (Feb 8, 2024), thus becoming mandatory.

Comments are welcome. Please feel free to address us via the comment functionality.

Changes Stemming directly from WCAG 2.2

- obsolete Req: [ACC-266 Correct Use of Markup Language](#) (update October 2023: no efforts - always supported)
- new SC for [ACC-267 Consistent Navigation and help \(new version\)](#) :
 - ACC-267.2 Consistent Help - active elements
 - ACC-267.3 Consistent Help - inactive elements
- new SC for [ACC-270 Full Input Channel Support \(Keyboard, Mouse, Touch\) \(new version\)](#):
 - [ACC-270.19 Alternative for Dragging \(further background\)](#)
- new SC for [ACC-271 Visible Focus \(new version\)](#):
 - ACC-271.3 Focus Not Obscured
- new Req: [ACC-285 Accessible Authentication](#)
 - ACC-285.1 Accessible Authentication
 - ACC-285.2 Accessible Authentication (no object recognition)
 - ACC-285.3 Accessible Authentication (no content identification))
- New Req: [ACC-286 Avoidance of Redundant Entries](#)
 - ACC-286.1 Avoidance of Redundant Entries
- New Req: [ACC-287 Target Size](#)
 - ACC-287.1 Target Size

For further information, the W3C page "[What's New in WCAG 2.2 Working Draft](#)" might be of interest. Please note that several success criteria have changed since the last public working draft was published.

Changes Stemming from changes in WCAG 2.x

In WCAG 2.2, the Success Criterion 4.1.1 Parsing was set to obsolete and removed, see [WCAG 2 FAQ - Parsing](#) and [Understanding SC 4.1.1: Parsing \(Obsolete and removed\)](#).

[WCAG 2.1, 4.1.1](#) and [WCAG 2.0, 4.1.1](#) have been republished with a note saying "this Success Criterion should be considered as always satisfied for any content using HTML or XML."

As a consequence, the [ACC-266 Correct Use of markup language](#) requirement is always set to fulfilled for html based frontends since Oct 5, 2023.

Of course, static tests remain an important pillar to find accessibility issues.

Issues which used to be reported with ACC-266.1 through ACC-266.4 now are reported with ACC-264.1.

Changes Basing on Experience around WCAG

- new Success Criteria:
 - new SC for [ACC-262 Color and Contrast setting \(new version\)](#)
 - ACC-262.6 Theme Robustness
 - ACC-262.7 Theme selection according to OS settings
 - new SC for [ACC-264 Interoperability with Assistive Technologies \(new version\)](#)
 - ACC-264.5 consistent text alternatives
- changes:

- change SC: change ACC-253.4 to "Is information on the input and required entries provided for the user?" changing the order of 'required entries' and 'input'.
 - Reason: In its current wording, the SC is understood as asking only for markers with required entries.
 - Reason: [WCAG 2.1, 3.3.2, Level A, Labels or Instructions](#) explicitly requests information on entries to be made, like for example a date pattern.
- change req: change [ACC-258](#) to "UI elements with the same function have consistent appearance and are consistently labeled and used throughout the product." This way, it is clarified that a consistent appearance is requested, not a prerequisite.
 - Reason: In the benefits they explicitly state: "When non-text content is used in a consistent way to identify components with the same functionality, people with difficulty reading text or detecting text alternatives can interact with the Web without depending on text alternatives."
 - Reason: the corresponding SC already request it.
- change SC: change [ACC-258.3](#) to "Are icons and other non-text elements that are used to identify certain functions used consistently?" saying 'icons and other non-text elements' instead of 'bitmap images'. Also, add a reference to [WCAG 2.1, 3.2.4, Level AA, Consistent Identification](#) 
 - Reason: 'bitmap images' is a technical term, rather focus on the experience in the UI
 - Reason: bitmaps are technically outdated or not understood to refer to icons as well
 - Reason: The WCAG explicitly names "icons or other non-text items " in this context.
- change wording in [ACC-262 Color and Contrast setting \(new version\)](#) to accommodate for the new SC
- change Req and SC (wording): change [ACC-267](#) to "Navigational UI elements have to be provided at the same place and the same order among the screens or pages of the application." saying 'navigational UI elements' instead of 'navigation areas'.
 - Reason: avoid misunderstanding
- change SC (wording): change [ACC-270.1](#) to "Can every interactive UI element be accessed using each input channel keyboard, mouse, or touch?" adding 'each input channel'
 - Reason: avoid misunderstanding
- change SC ACC-270.12 to reflect ACC-270.21 Concurrent Input Mechanisms (from WCAG 2.1), see [ACC-270 Full Input Channel Support \(Keyboard, Mouse, Touch\) \(new version\)](#)
 - Reason: we already live and test it, now it reflects the previously suggested SC ACC-270.21

Dropped changes (in case of interest)

If changes planned at some point of time have been withdrawn, you can find them here in case of interest, in reverse chronological order (that is, most recent decision first).

- new SC for [ACC-271 Focus Visible \(new version\)](#):
 - ACC-271.3 Consistent Focus Visualization (withdrawn)
 - ACC-271.4 Unique Focus Visualization (withdrawn)
- new SC: [ACC-283.5 Enhanced Spacing \(line\)](#) (withdrawn)
- new SC: [ACC-283.6 Enhanced Spacing \(paragraph\)](#) (with ACC-283.5) (withdrawn)
- New level: [ACC-271 Visible Focus](#) (Level A instead of Level AA) (this change is no longer found in WCAG 2.2 pages, as of Jan 10, 2024))
- [ACC-271.3 Focus Appearance](#) (was moved to AAA in WCAG 2.2)
- [ACC-285 Navigable Reference Points](#) (was dropped from WCAG 2.2)
- [ACC-286 Visible Controls](#) (was dropped from WCAG 2.2)